149 **Fifteen were Hindus and included Raja Birbal:** Parmeshwar P. Sinha, *Raja Birbal – Life and Times*, New Delhi: Janaki Prakashan, 1980, p. 58.

149 **'including a breastplate, backplate, and two smaller pieces':** *Journal of Asian History*, Vols. 19–20, 1985, p. 208.

150 **'This is the army of the Emperor, which has come from Fatehpur':** Moosvi, *Episodes in the Life of Akbar*, p. 47.

150 **'And if it is the imperial army, where are the imperial elephants?':** Ibid., p. 48.

150 **'if this time too a daughter comes':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 83.

150 **'If you wish to retain our affection':** Ibid., p. 83.

151 **'This Prince,' wrote Monserrate:** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 196.

151 **'Which of these men captured you?':** Ibid., p. 49.

151 **grabbed a spear, and flung it at the man:** Elliot, *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, Vol. 5, p. 367.

152 **constructed with some 1,000 heads of the fallen enemy:** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, p. 172.

152 **They were dragged into court, to the horror, bemusement, and chilled amusement of the courtiers:** Nizamuddin Ahmad, *Tabakat-i Akbari of Nizam-ud-din Ahmad Bakhshi*, Lahore: Sind Sagar, 1975 (repr.), p. 26.

152 **During the same year plague and famine visited Gujarat:** Qandahari, *Tarikh-i Akbari*, p. 232–33.

153 **'of such austere life that he first feeds his cattle with corn':** Jarrett (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vols. 2 & 3, p. 31.

154 **'assembly erupted in such a roar of congratulations':** Faruqui, *The Princes of the Mughal Empire*, p. 146.

154 **'a coat without lining of the Indian form':** Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, p. 88.

155 **'absurd style':** Badauni quoted in Schimmel, *The Empire of the Great Mughals*, p. 170.

155 **made from shahtoos, the soft wool from the underbellies of mountain goats:** Schimmel, *The Empire of the Great Mughals*, p. 170.

155 **introduced the word sarbgati (covering the whole body) for jama:** Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, p. 90.

155 **courtiers all wore small, compact, 'atpati' turbans:** *The British Library Journal*, Vols. 1–3, p. 159.

155 **he took to wearing as a sarpech (turban ornament):** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 409.

155 **'In society,' warned the eighteenth-century Mirza Namah:** Stephen P. Blake, *Shahjahanabad: The Sovereign City in Mughal India, 1639–1739*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1991, p. 138.

156 **A great portion of the life of the students is wasted:** Blochmann (trans.), *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol 1, p. 278.

156 **'to overcome deficiencies in weight or height':** Stephen P. Blake, 'Courtly Culture under Babur and the Early Mughals', *Journal of Asian History*, Vol. 20, No. 2, 1986, p. 207.

157 **'At that time in Muscovy':** Robert K. Massie, *Peter the Great: His Life and Work*, New York: Knopf, 1981.

157 **'The wise sovereign':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 105.

158 **'I have not so much affection for my own mother as for her':** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 78.

158 **'famed as a consummate gatherer of rumour, gossip, news and intelligence':** Faruqui, *The Princes of the Mughal Empire*, p. 147.